

# Diabetes - Low Blood Sugar - Female (Child)

Algorithm 1074 | Child (0-17 years) | Gender at birth: Female

## Definition

- Hypoglycemia (low blood sugar) assessment decomposed from NHS.UK's published when-to-get-help guidance.
- Child patient.
- Female.

## Clinical background

- Hypoglycaemia is usually a blood-glucose level below 4 mmol/L and should be treated promptly.
- Symptoms can include hunger, sweating, shaking, dizziness, weakness, visual change, irritability, palpitations, and confusion.
- An unconscious person must not be given food or drink by mouth; emergency escalation depends on recovery and glucagon availability.

## Initial assessment

1. [OPEN\_TEXT] What is the person's exact age and sex, are they pregnant, what glucose reading and units are shown, what symptoms are present, and what does their personal diabetes/hypoglycaemia plan say?
2. [YES\_NO] Is a glucagon injection available and does someone know how to use it?
3. [YES\_NO] Has the person been drinking alcohol?
4. [CAREGIVER\_OBSERVATION] What change has the parent or caregiver observed in behaviour, alertness, eating or drinking, sleep, school or play, and normal activity?

## Triage and redirect questions

### 1. Redirect → Diabetes - High Blood Sugar

Is the measured glucose high rather than below 4 mmol/L, with thirst, frequent urination, or other hyperglycaemia symptoms?

NHS.UK distinguishes hyperglycaemia from hypoglycaemia; a high reading belongs in the high-blood-sugar pathway.

### 1. Disposition level 100

Is the person unresponsive or unconscious, AND is a glucagon injection unavailable, or has one already been given without recovery within 10 minutes, or has the person been drinking alcohol?

NHS.UK low blood sugar guidance lists these as call-999 criteria for severe hypoglycemia.

### 1. Disposition level 15

Is the person conscious and able to swallow safely, with none of the features above?

NHS.UK guidance provides the fast-acting sugar treatment steps for a conscious person with low blood sugar.

## Advice

### *Qatar emergency low-blood-sugar response*

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 and do not drive for reduced consciousness, seizure, unsafe swallowing, severe confusion/aggression, injury, or failure to improve under the person's approved plan. Give prescribed glucagon only if it is available and the helper is trained, following the product/personal plan. Do not give anything by mouth to a drowsy, seizing, or unsafe-to-swallow person; use the recovery position if breathing. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
- Call Back If: no improvement under the prescribed rescue plan; worsening unresponsiveness; seizure or abnormal breathing.

### *Governed fast-acting carbohydrate treatment*

- Only if fully awake and swallowing safely, follow the person's clinician-approved diabetes plan for fast-acting carbohydrate and timed glucose recheck. Product, amount, repeat interval, follow-on food, insulin/pump adjustment, and pediatric/pregnancy actions require the approved Qatar protocol; do not improvise exact doses. Escalate to 999 for deterioration or failure to respond.
- Call Back If: no improvement according to the personal plan; level of consciousness or swallowing worsens; seizure or recurrent episode.

## First aid

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 and do not drive for reduced consciousness, seizure, unsafe swallowing, severe confusion/aggression, injury, or failure to improve under the person's approved plan. Give prescribed glucagon only if it is available and the helper is trained, following the product/personal plan. Do not give anything by mouth to a drowsy, seizing, or unsafe-to-swallow person; use the recovery position if breathing. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.

## References

- NHS.UK, "Low blood sugar (hypoglycaemia)", <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/low-blood-sugar-hypoglycaemia/> (page last reviewed 03 August 2023)

## Provenance

Shaped to mirror the licensed After-Hours Telehealth Triage Guidelines database structure. This is IST open-source guideline content derived from the cited NHS.UK pages under the Open Government Licence v3.0; it is not licensed STCC content.

Question.DispositionLevel=null marks a See More Appropriate Guideline redirect and is not a disposition row. Local disposition mappings and TelemedicineEligible values require IST clinical governance approval. UAT DATA ONLY - NOT FOR REAL-PATIENT CARE OR PRODUCTION USE.

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